

A *6* - Year Look at
Outcomes | Income | & Agency
of codeHive Graduates



Investing in the Future of Work:

How codeHive Graduates are Leading the Way

Six years ago, we made a decision that would ripple outward, changing lives, reshaping futures, and redefining what's possible for young women in tech.

We went all in, not just on teaching code, but on creating a space where young women could grow into their full potential. Choosing a residential model wasn't the easiest path, but it was the one that mattered most. We believed that with the right structure, support, and environment, our students wouldn't just find jobs, they'd go on to drive change in their communities, industries, and beyond.

At the time, it was a bold experiment. Today, it's a proven model.

This report offers a rare and powerful look at what happens when you invest deeply and consistently in talent. It tracks six cohorts of codeHive graduates from 2019 through 2024 and captures their journeys not just into the workforce, but into a future many were never expected to reach.

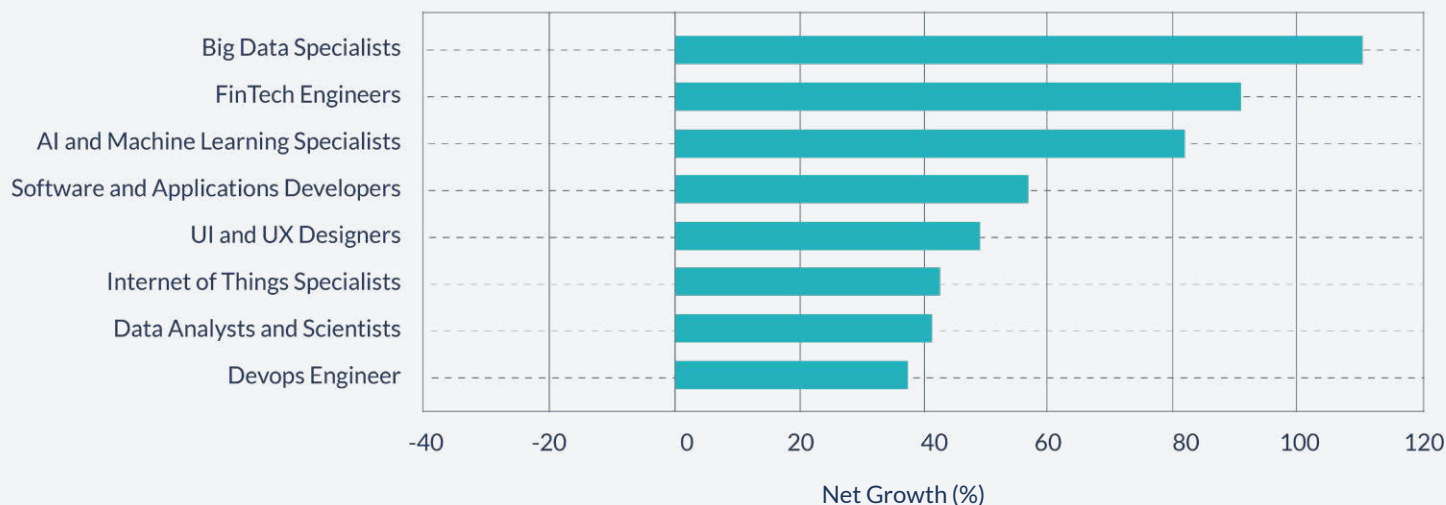
It shows incomes rising, fast. It shows growth that doesn't stop at the first job. And it shows something even more important: that the graduates who are earning the most aren't just technically skilled. They're confident. They're self-led. They're adaptable.

And now, as industries everywhere shift under the weight and potential of AI, our approach is shifting, too.

There's a lot of fear in the global conversation about artificial intelligence, fear that jobs will disappear, that people will be left behind. But our data tells a different story: AI isn't eliminating opportunity. It's raising the standard. It's rewarding those with the right skills and creating space for those bold enough to specialize.

A report by the [World Economic Forum](#) says that demand for AI and Machine Learning specialists is expected to grow by 40%, creating more than 1 million new jobs globally as these technologies drive transformation across industries, from healthcare and agriculture to finance and logistics.

Top Fastest Growing Jobs, 2025-2030



Source: World Economic Forum, Future of Jobs Report 2025

That's why we've doubled down on training in data science, machine learning, and AI. And the early results are already clear: graduates who pursue these paths are earning up to six times more than their peers in general software engineering roles. In fact, the highest early-career income across all six graduating classes belongs to a 2024 graduate in a machine learning role, just 180 days after finishing the program.

This report also reveals a powerful link between earning and agency. Our most successful graduates are not just equipped, they're empowered. They lead themselves. They believe in their ability to shape the world around them. That mindset alongside hard technical skills is what sets them apart in a rapidly evolving industry.

And as their careers grow, so does the return on investment. By year two, most codeHive graduates have already earned back the full cost of their training. By year ten, some will have earned it back fifteen times over.

This is the story of six years of learning, building, adapting and proving what's possible. It's a story of talent meeting opportunity, of specialization meeting demand, and of young women rising to lead in the industries that are shaping the future.

We didn't just build a program. We built a model that works. And this report shows exactly how and why.

Linda Kamau

Founder & Executive Director

The codeHive Model Works

For years, we've believed in the power of the codeHive program. Now, the data confirms it.

Over a two-year period, we conducted a quasi-experimental study to measure the employability outcomes of codeHive graduates compared to a control group of similar peers who did not participate in the program. Employability was measured through three primary lenses: monthly income (primary outcome), career advancement and promotion, and confidence in navigating the job market.

The study found that **six months** after graduating from the program, our alumni were earning nearly **three times more** than their peers who didn't join the program. Their median income was **\$359**, compared to just **\$125** for the control group.

Even more striking, by **June 2024**, this gap had widened, codeHive graduates were earning **3.3 times more**. This shows the impact is not just immediate but continues to build over time.

codeHive Graduates vs Control Group

Employability Outcomes



For those who secured **long-term software engineering roles**, the results were even more impressive: their earnings were **4.9 times higher** than non-participants.

That's a game-changing difference, not just in income, but in independence, confidence, and opportunity.

It's not just about landing a job. It's about showing up prepared, capable, and ready to lead. And now, we have the data to prove that our model works, and that it works at scale.

If the report proves that codeHive works, then the last six years tell the story of how deeply and consistently it works

The Top Line:

What Our Highest Earners Show Us

Over the past six cohorts, a clear pattern has emerged in the career trajectories of codeHive graduates: those who pursue **specialized, niche roles** particularly in fields such as **data science, machine learning, and AI** are achieving **faster and higher-earning outcomes** compared to their peers in more general software engineering positions.

While general software engineering is still a solid and reliable career path, data collected across all six graduating classes shows that specialization is increasingly being rewarded in the job market. Graduates who secure roles in data and ML consistently report **higher monthly incomes within the first six months of employment**, reflecting both the growing demand for these skill sets and the value of targeted training.

Highest Monthly income (2019 - 2024)



Class of 2024: When Talent Meets Timely Training

The early results from the class of 2024 tell a clear story: specialization is driving stronger outcomes, faster.

Graduates who are employed in data and machine learning roles are earning significantly more than their peers, with the highest monthly income **reaching \$1,900 within just 180 days of graduation.**

This isn't just a cohort highlight, it's the **highest 180-day income recorded across all six graduating classes.**

In contrast, those entering general software engineering roles are earning between **\$500 and \$800 per month** within the same period. Still solid, but a clear indication of how much more is possible when training aligns with emerging industry demand.

This growing income gap reflects one of codeHive's core strengths: adaptability. Over the past year, we've deepened our focus on data science, machine learning, and AI, making sure our students graduate not just with relevant skills, but with the ones that matter most in today's tech economy.

AI, Data, and ML Roles: Driving 4.9X Higher Earnings Across Cohorts

Across all six cohorts, graduates who move into specialized roles in AI, data science, and machine learning consistently earn **4.9X** times more than those in general software engineering positions.

This trend is especially clear among earlier cohorts from 2019 to 2021, who have transitioned into these niche fields through ongoing **upskilling opportunities offered through codeHiveX.**

Upskilling is a core pillar of codeHiveX, designed to keep our graduates ahead of industry demands and open doors to high-paying, in-demand roles. This continued investment in skills development not only boosts earnings but also ensures our alumni remain competitive and adaptable in a rapidly evolving tech landscape.

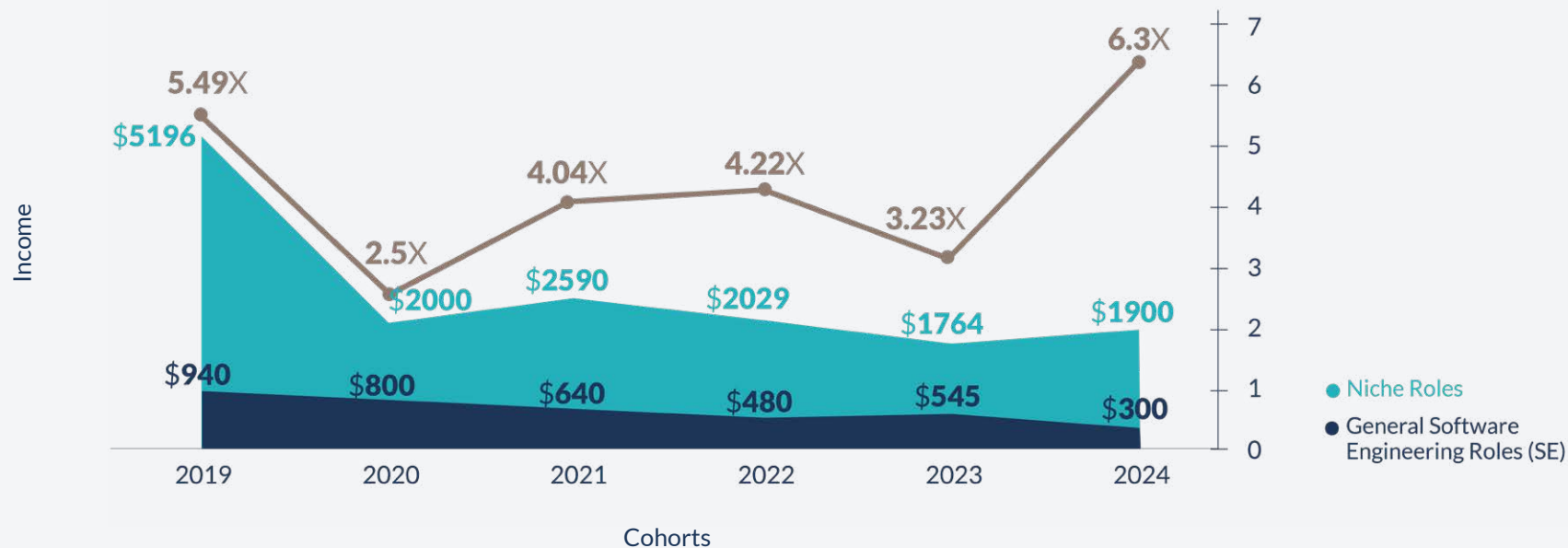
The graph below illustrates the significant income difference between niche and general software roles across cohorts, proof that specialization pays off, both immediately and over the long term.

The graph illustrates a clear and consistent trend: graduates who pursue niche roles, particularly in data science, machine learning, and AI, significantly out-earn their peers in general software engineering roles across all cohorts.

- » The income advantage is not limited to recent graduates. Even those from earlier cohorts like **2019 and 2020** who upskill into niche areas have seen dramatic increases in earnings.
- » In some cohorts, the income gap is as high as **5.5X**, showing that specialization can be a game-changer, regardless of when a student graduated.

The overall average? Across all cohorts, those in niche roles earn **4.9X times more** than those in general roles.

Niche Roles Driving Higher Earning



Graduates in niche tech roles, like AI and machine learning, consistently out-earn their peers across all cohorts, often by more than 3–5 times.

The Soft Power Behind Hard Results

What's behind the success of our highest earners? Technical skills matter and specialization pays but there's something deeper at work.

We've always believed that young women need more than skills to succeed, they need the mindset to lead.

Our data shows a clear correlation: graduates with higher agency scores consistently earn more. In other words, the graduates unlocking the most transformative career and income outcomes aren't just technically capable, they also demonstrate strong **self-belief, leadership, environmental awareness, and self-governance**.

This is no accident. At the heart of the codeHive model is a deliberate focus on building agency. It's baked into the learning experience from mentorship and leadership development to peer collaboration and decision-making.

Among graduates from the 2019 to 2021 cohorts, those with higher agency scores are significantly more likely to have moved into higher-paying, specialized roles. The data points to a powerful insight: **Agency isn't just personal growth it's economic empowerment.**

Higher agency scores track closely with higher earning graduates, especially in niche tech roles.



High income. High agency. High return.

We are standing at a pivotal moment. The tech industry is evolving rapidly, and codeHive is positioned to evolve with it. Our ability to adapt, to anticipate market needs, and to train for the future ensures that our graduates stay ahead of the curve.

Over the past six years, the evidence is undeniable: the codeHive model is delivering strong, measurable outcomes and doing so with efficiency.

Graduates are entering the job market quickly. They're earning more than their peers. And their income continues to grow over time, especially as they move into specialized roles in fields like data, AI, and machine learning.

But what truly sets this apart is the **return on investment**.

These figures reflect the **ratio of income earned by a graduate over time** compared to the cost of training. By year 2, most graduates have already earned back the equivalent of their training cost. By year 5, they've earned more than **four times** that amount. And by year 10, some will have earned over **15x**.

This kind of return speaks to the **long-term value of an adaptive, high-quality technical and leadership education**. It confirms that investing in young women's potential when paired with the right tools, environment, and skills results in scalable, compounding economic impact.

The high ROI shows that the codeHive model is built to scale impact over time.

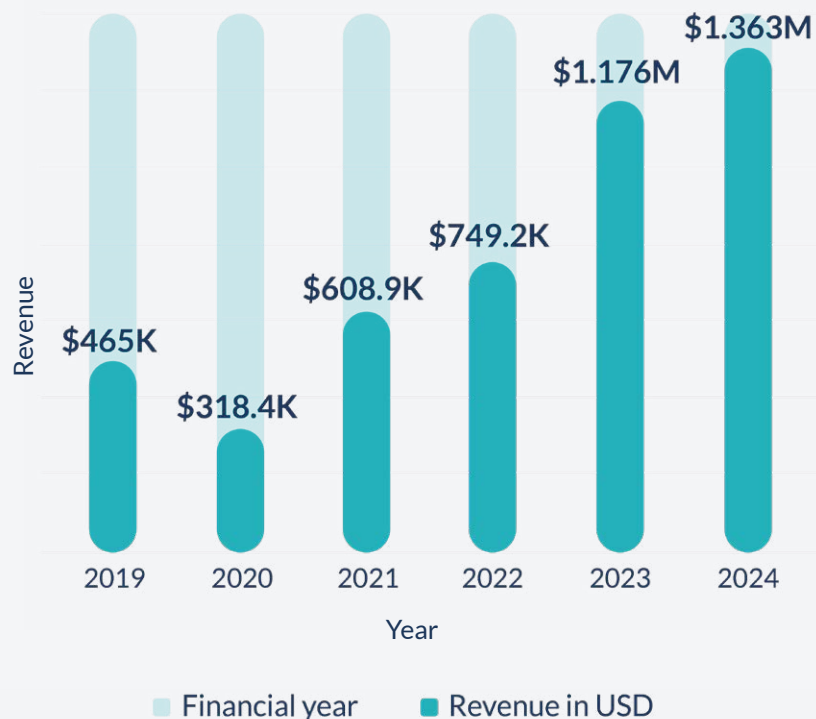
Ratio of Income Earned Over Time



Financials

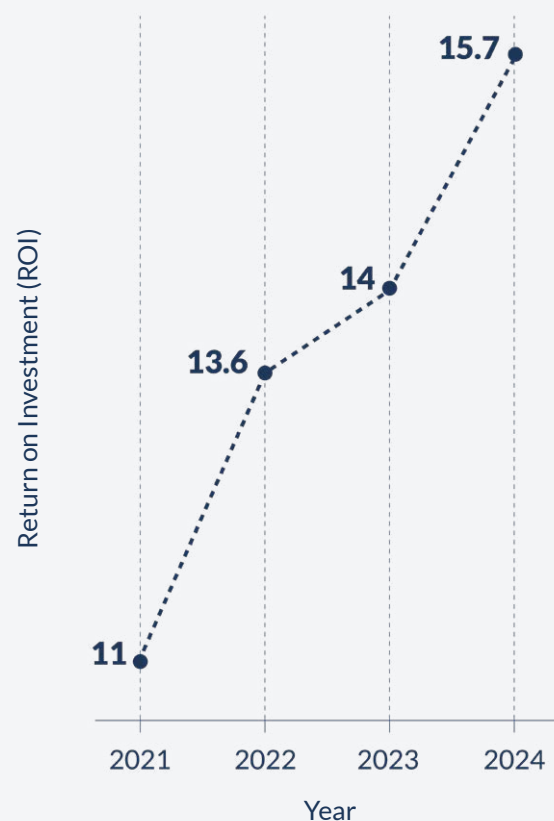
AkiraChix has seen a steady growth in revenue in the last 6 years. This has ensured the gradual growth experienced in the program is sustainably resourced leading to more measurable impact.

Revenue Growth (2019 -2024)



What do these revenues represent from a cost effectiveness perspective? In 2021, an evaluation was conducted to understand the cost effectiveness of the codeHive model. We have continuously tracked the ROI to ensure every dollar spent has an equal if not higher return on investment.

Cost Effectiveness of the codeHive model



As the tech landscape continues to shift, one thing remains clear: the **future belongs to those who are ready to lead it. And our graduates are doing just that.**

Through a combination of **specialized, high-demand skills** and a deeply embedded focus on **agency and leadership**, codeHive alumni are not just stepping into the workforce, they're standing out in it.

The data speaks for itself: those who pursue niche roles in AI, data, and machine learning are earning significantly more, and those with higher agency scores are consistently unlocking the most transformative outcomes. This is the result of a deliberate model, one that doesn't just teach skills, but nurtures **confidence, critical thinking, and adaptability.**

As we look ahead, our mission remains unchanged: to equip young women not only for the jobs of today, but for the opportunities and challenges of tomorrow. Because when potential is matched with purpose, the results aren't just impressive.

They're unstoppable.

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